Once More To See You

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/34538572.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F, F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow (She-Ra), Adora & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra)

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Part 1 of Once More To See You

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by SpilltheKatea

Summary

Finding out youre a fabled magical princess thanks to a talking magic sword in the woods would come as a shock to most but especially so when youre a man.

After a surprise encounter with his destiny deep within the whispering woods, Horde Cadet Adam quickly finds himself turning against the only home he ever knew and becoming the one thing he was always taught to hate but he soon finds the line between himself and his super powered alter ego blurring by the day.

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Au where everything's basically the same but Adora is a repressed trans woman and is very much not having a very good time.

Notes

Hey Everyone! Ive been thinking about this fic for a LONG awhile! This is literally my first public fic so please forgive any mistakes or wierd phrasings, please be nice!

CW for Repression , gender dysphoria, misgendering and Shadow Weaver in general. If you have a problem with Memory Stuff/Mind Control itd be a good idea to stay away from this!

Thanks to Ivory and Vult on discord for being so kind to beta read this for me and thank you so much for reading ^^

Adam had still not gotten used to the quiet of Bright Moon at night. No whirls of machinery, no creaks of pipes and no gentle purring from the foot of his bed. The absence of the latter left a sinking feeling in his stomach, reminding him of the life he'd left behind..

The lights of the Whispering Woods reflected in through the giant windows, illuminating his new quarters in soft purple light.

Wrapped tightly in his bed, he tossed and turned, restless and sleepless-- unable to do anything but stare at the intricately painted ceiling and ponder the last few days. Nestled on a thick cot he specifically picked out, he could not understand how his new friends could sleep on what amounted to a giant pillow. There was a lot he didn't understand.

Why their food came in so many other strange forms than just two simple bars for example. Why there was no strict schedule. It was chaotic, disorganised and unproductive--yet so freeing.

There was one last thing, however, that itched at the back of his mind--no matter how hard he tried to push it back, no matter how many times it was ignored. As soon as he closed his eyes it all came rushing back.

A glistening sword raised, that strange phrase echoing, forced out of his lips by some strange unknown force, engulfing him in a golden light burning everything he was and was meant to be away, replaced with unnatural unlimited power tightly wound into the form of a giant princess.

He felt strange, he felt powerful, he felt beautiful, he felt *right* …

****

The twin moons had started to disappear, vanishing beneath the horizon as beams of sunlight trickled their way into Adam's room.

Still sleepless, he crawled out of bed, standing by his regal walk-in closet. It was bigger than even the highest-ranking Force Captain's entire quarters. (Bar Weaver, but no one had ever seen her sleep.)

He stared inside the newly barren room, having been hastily cleaned out after his surprise arrival. It was bare now, aside from his usual uniform and the numerous crop tops Bow had excitedly gifted to him much to Glimmer's disapproval.

Glimmer had excitedly told him of all the parties and events he'd "get" to go to now that he was a "prince" (though the title was honorary, whatever that meant), but the idea stung worse than any taser the Horde could throw at him.

A pile of dress shirts, suits and whatever Glimmer could find after excitedly scavenging through the castle after finding out that he too was invited to "Princess Prom". The mere thought of being stuck in one of these tight silky get-ups for an entire evening was already draining his non-existent energy.

A delicate mirror stood at the centre of the room, enticingly tempting him forward.

He approaches it tightly, clutching the sword, dragging it along the marble floor behind him. Reflected back at him is a strange person, a face he's seen all his life but still can't quite recognise. A lean athletic young man, broad shoulders fitting awkwardly on his frame, a mop of blonde hair tickling his ears--he stares straight back at himself, tired and lifeless.

The Sword of Protection hangs tight in his hand, the hilt seeming to fit perfectly as if it was made for him. But the truth still burns inside him. In every single legend, every centuries-old tale of the various She-Ras across the history of Etheria, no matter what changed from story to story there was always one single

fundamental constant, She-Ra is always a woman, no matter her species, no matter her allegiance, this was always true. But then there's him.

"Why do you work for me?" he pleads desperately, as if the inanimate sword could ever respond.

He holds the sword up high to the sky as he whispers those hallowed words, careful to not wake up the entire castle like the last time he had a midnight identity crisis.

"For the honor of Grayskull!" echoes around the room as a wave of relief and confusion radiates through his body, a golden light surrounding him as if it were a cocoon.

Glowing crystal-blue eyes flutter open, disoriented and confused before once again making contact with the figure in the mirror.

A bright warm feeling fills his chest as …. *her* reflection becomes clear.

The small, weak runaway horde soldier replaced with a strong, powerful princess. Something better, something eternal. She-Ra.

The weirdest thing about this strange new power, this strange new form, was that even though it was so alien, it still felt so familiar. Familiar, yet improved.

Her eyes are brighter, crystal blue shimmering in the night, an unkempt greased mullet replaced with giant waves of glistening blonde hair puffing around her waist, softer than even the most extravagant of Bright Moon's silks.

Tight shining armour hugs her curves, proudly displaying her feminine form and bulging muscles...Adam had spent so long rigorously training to be the strongest he could be, every free hour spent training and training and training. He had been proud of his toned body for a while, but compared to this, compared to *her,* he's nothing.

As she steps closer and closer to the glimmering mirror illuminated by the rising sun, everything is so much clearer. the colours are brighter, she can hear the birds chirping in the trees by her room welcoming a new day, a decades-old fog is lifting in her head.

Crystal blue meets crystal blue reflected.

She reaches out her hand to touch her reflection, still not used to the slender feminine hand meeting her reflection, staring deep into her own eyes as tears begin to form. Locked in a deep trance, a realisation is crawling from the deepest parts of her head, a realisation that had been locked away for years.

“It’s me?” she says in an unfamiliar feminine voice previously heard only in the heat of battle. Half as if stating a fact, but also as if it was a question to no one in particular.

“It’s me.”

She stares in the mirror for what feels like an eternity, in disbelief as to how she could ever look like this...but she loves it! She doesn’t know if it’s her unbreakable strength or the deep rooted powerful magic or maybe even, for some reason, the fact no one could ever look at her like this and think she was a man. She doesn’t know why but that thought fills her heart, her body heating up as if cradled in a warm hug.

A familiar feeling sparks in her, a ticking clock, reminding her of just how temporary this form is.

“Five more minutes,” she pleads desperately to no one in particular, trying to hold onto THIS for just a while longer, but eventually no matter how hard she struggles, her grasp slips. The golden light returns flickering in and out, surrounding her body once again.

Her body shrinking, twisting, deforming and corrupting and where once the fierce princess stood now stands just him.

In a matter of seconds everything comes rushing back, her confidence demolished, washing away to the gutter of his mind.

He starts to feel too tall, too big and too hairy, but a new sensation strikes him. A gnawing sensation, a phantom pain stabbing his chest, spreading through his body, burning it and freezing it all at the same time.

He wants to go back, he *has* to go back.

****

Lying there on his tough yet comfortable cot, staring up aimlessly, his mind unable to keep himself from drifting back to the many nights he spent on a similar one back in the Fright Zone. Those days are already starting to feel like a lifetime ago, unable to not thoughts about *her* overtake his mind. .

He hopes *she* realises, sees how wrong the Horde is, how much pain they've caused, just how happy and free she truly could be. He longs for the day he can fight side by side with his truest, closest friend again.

Visions of her smirk during mid-morning training, her claws slashing through bots like paper flying through scissors, not slashing apart him apart instead. The way her chest would sputter and purr when no one else was watching, curled up by the bottom of their bunk every night in the cold hostile barracks.

Happy and safe, that's all he's ever wanted for the both of them.

But for now all he can wish for is that she's not as cold,alone and confused as he is. But knowing the Horde...that won't come true.

His eyes heavy, he turns over, hoping to get at least a few more minutes of sleep before his 6 AM training, letting the gentle void overtake him for just a little while.

****

Memories come flooding back of a scared child in the Fright Zone never understanding why they were lumped in with Rogelio and Kyle during their training drills, instead of Catra and Lonnie.

"But I'm like them, aren't I?!" a squeaky, confused voice echoed upwards.

"We are all alike in the Horde, but there are some differences that are still important here, boy..."

That word paining him in a way he didn't quite have the words to understand,

A junior horde cadet barely into his teens, his hair having finally grown long for the first time after months of effort, feeling a relief and joy from the tickling on his neck.

The dozens of occasional "Ma'ams" and "Misses" from strangers who's first impressions of him were from behind, the hectic "Sir" that would inevitably be apologetically spat out not dulling the euphoria of the latter comment.

The constant reminders of his less than ideal height and unwanted femininity initially caused a lot of embarrassment for the young cadet, and he very much did hate that mocking nickname his best friend would constantly call him at every opportunity. ut it did grow on him after a while, no idea why, but it always felt warm, fuzzy and...right.

Adora was such a pretty name...

Memories flutter through his sleeping brain, some half stuck, half remembered as if something had surgically plucked them out with

tweezers but left the residue behind, sticking to his mind like old bubble-gum under a warm bus seat.

****

A strange unfamiliar girl, barely sixteen years old, sits atop a small balcony overlooking the Fright Zone. If you were to ask Adam to recall this girl's appearance after this dream, he would say that she could be best described as a void. It was if something existed where she sat. She had a nose, a mouth, eyes and a face, she was no doubt a person but at the same time completely indescribable.

She winced as a loud crash snapped her out of her trance but was relieved as she met the amber-blue mismatched eyes of the smirking woman perched beside her…Catra, holding a handful of bottles of strange pills, obviously stolen from the Horde medical wards.

"Miss me?"

A red blush grows across her face as she chokes up, completely flustered.

"Well…" Catra mutters, placing the strange pills into her grasp before curling her tail around her quickly growing curves, leaning her head against her broad shoulder, a light purr echoing as she begins twirling strands of long blonde hair between one hand while the other drags her face closer and closer.."i missed you too… dork"

A sound that could best be described as a "chirp" pops out as the woman's lips meet her feline companion's.

As this strange stress-induced fever dream fades away, Adam can't help but feel a strange, dark, deep-rooted pang of a hazy unknown emotion in his subconscious, something he can't quite

place and something best left buried, for now at least. Why did this all feel so…familiar?

****

Adam doesn't know how or know why, but as he gently wakes to a new day, the afternoon sun lightly tickling his face, something that had been brewing these last few weeksfinally clicks, the bright feeling of being She-Ra still stuck in him. His chest warms up at just the thought of transforming again. Of being *her* again.

It finally hits him: why he feels so comfortable in that golden battle skirt, why moving and fighting as She-Ra feels so much more natural than as Adam, why he so desperately wants to immediately yell the magical phrase at the top of his lungs.

It’s the power.

She’s so powerful, she’s so strong. Anything She-Ra wants to do, she can do it. Adam can’t protect his friends, Adam can’t defeat the horde, Adam can’t fulfill his destiny, but She-Ra can.

She-Ra is everything he’s not, of course he’d be so depressed if unlimited power was stripped from him after such a short time using it.

It’s clear to him now. What he needs to do, who he needs to become.

“I want to be She-Ra forever.”

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